

Question:

A baby is born after the 32nd gestational week by cesarean delivery. The mother suffered from gestational diabetes; however, she had no other pregnancy-related diseases and was otherwise healthy. The baby has a blood pressure of 100/58 mm Hg, heart rate of 104/min, and oxygen saturation of 88%. The child has tachypnea, subcostal and intercostal retractions, nasal flaring, and cyanosis. The cyanosis is responding well to initial administration of oxygen. The nasogastric tube was positioned without problems. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)
- B. Tracheoesophageal fistula
- C. Pneumonia
- D. Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt

Reasoning + Answer:

<answer> A . Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS) </answer>

<think> Reasoning process here :

- 1 . **Gestational age**: The baby was born after the 32 nd gestational week , which indicates that the baby is a pre term infant .
- 2 . **Symptoms**: The baby is experiencing tachypnea , subcostal and intercostal retractions , nasal flaring , and cyanosis , which are common symptoms of respiratory distress .
- 3 . **Cyanosis responding to oxygen**: The cyanosis is responding well to initial administration of oxygen , which suggests that the baby's respiratory distress is likely due to a respiratory issue rather than a cardiac issue .
- 4 . **Absence of other symptoms**: There is no mention of other symptoms such as fever , vomiting , or abdominal pain , which might be associated with pneumonia or other conditions .
- 5 . **Positioning of nasogastric tube**: The nasogastric tube was positioned without problems , which suggests that the baby's respiratory system is functioning well enough to accommodate the tube .
- 6 . **Health of the mother**: The mother had gestational diabetes , but there is no indication that this would directly affect the baby's respiratory system .
- 7 . **Pre term birth**: The baby was born after the 32 nd gestational week , which increases the risk of respiratory distress syndrome due to the immaturity of the lungs .
- 8 . **Comparison of options**:
 - B . Tracheoesophageal fistula is unlikely as it would likely cause more severe symptoms such as difficulty feeding and aspiration .
 - C . Pneumonia would likely present with fever and other signs of infection .
 - D . Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt would likely cause cyanosis that does not respond to oxygen therapy .
 - A . Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS) is a common condition in pre term infants , characterized by difficulty breathing and respiratory distress , which aligns with the symptoms presented .</think>